



c. 600 BCE

REGENERATION OF BABYLON

Nebuchadnezzar II, ruler of the Neo-Babylonian Empire (r. 605–562 BCE), was an inspirational military leader and became known for his building projects throughout Mesopotamia. He ordered the regeneration of the city of Babylon to restore its fading reputation, including the rebuilding of the ziggurat and – legend has it – the creation of the famous hanging gardens.

◀ The legendary hanging gardens of Babylon

600 BCE

590 BCE The Nubian rulers of the Kingdom of Kush move their residence from Napata to Meroë

587 BCE Nebuchadnezzar II destroys the temple in Jerusalem following a Jewish revolt

c. 550 BCE The Temple of Artemis in Ephesus is rebuilt to replace the original destroyed by floods

550 BCE CYRUS THE GREAT FOUNDS THE ACHAEMENID EMPIRE

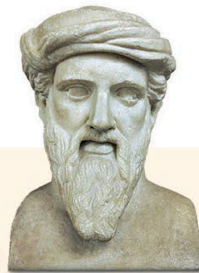
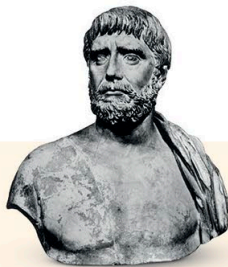
Cyrus was a king of Anshan, a subject nation of the Median Empire. He led a revolt, defeating the Medians and then conquering the Lydian Empire to form a new Achaemenid Empire, the First Persian Empire. Subsequently, Babylon also fell under Achaemenid rule, leading Cyrus to declare on an inscribed clay cylinder “I am Cyrus, King of the World”.



△ The Cyrus Cylinder

600–322 BCE

GREEK
PHILOSOPHY



The foundations of western philosophy were laid by Greek thinkers, beginning in the 6th century BCE and reaching a high point in Classical Athens.

c. 600 BCE Thales of Miletus is one of the first thinkers to speculate about what everything in the universe is made of.

c. 530 BCE Pythagoras founds a school of mathematics and philosophy in a commune in Italy.

399 BCE Socrates, first of the great Athenian philosophers, is accused of corrupting youths and disrespecting the gods; he drinks hemlock rather than renounce his views.

c. 387 BCE Plato, a protégé of Socrates, founds the Academy in Athens, where he presents his ideas to students from all Greece.